```
  files = Dir[pattern]
  rm(files, verbose: true) unless files.empty?
end

desc "Remove files whose names end with a tilde"
task :delete_unix_backups do
  delete("*~")
end

desc "Remove files with a .bak extension"
task :delete_windows_backups do
  delete("*.bak")
end

desc "Remove Unix and Windows backup files"
task delete_backups: [:delete_unix_backups, :delete_windows_backups] do
  puts "All backups deleted"
end
```

All these tasks as written use the current directory, but you might want to run the task on an arbitrary directory passed via the command line. Something like rake delete_unix_backups subdir. There is just one problem, though:

```
$ rake delete_unix_backups subdir
Don't know how to build task 'subdir'
(See the list of available tasks with `rake --tasks`)
```

Rake interprets a command-line argument as another task to run. (Rake doesn't interpret flag arguments like -d as tasks, but that doesn't really help us here.)

If you do want to pass a command-line argument to Rake, you have a couple of options. Rake has a mechanism to allow command-line arguments, but it's a little convoluted.

First, you need to define the arguments in the task, the syntax sets them up as extra arguments in the task definition:

```
def delete(dir, pattern)
  files = Dir["#{dir}/#{pattern}"]
  rm(files, verbose: true) unless files.empty?
end

desc "Remove files with a .bak extension"
task :delete_windows_backups, [:dir] do
  delete(args[:dir], "*.bak")
end

desc "Remove files whose names end with a tilde"
task :delete_unix_backups, [:dir] do |t, args|
  delete(args[:dir], "*~")
end

task :delete_backups, [:dir]: [:delete_unix_backups, :delete_windows_backups]
```

So, the second argument to the task is an array of the names of all the expected command-line arguments. If the task has both dependencies and expected command-line arguments, then the hash is keyed off the command-line arguments, as in task :delete_backups, [:dir]: [:delete_unix_backups, :delete_windows_backups]. The block that defines the task takes a new argument, which this code calls args. That argument is a hash, the keys are the names specified